SHAHRAM AJLOO

Senior Portfolio Manager · Asset-backed trading, pricing and portfolio risk

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Centrica Energy · Senior Portfolio Manager · Aalborg / Copenhagen / Antwerp

Application: Senior Portfolio Manager, Centrica Energy (R0084135)

For the Portfolio Management team

A power purchase agreement is a long-term bet on how a machine will behave: how often the wind drops, how much a battery has degraded by year nine, how much output a grid operator will actually let through on a Sunday in July. The price is set by a model. The truth is in the asset. I have spent twenty years on the asset side — running 24/7 plant, commissioning new equipment and cutting energy consumption by more than 40 % on a live site — and the last three years building the commercial models that turn those numbers into prices. That is where I want to sit: pricing profitable offtake against real asset behaviour, across the power markets Centrica Energy trades.

I would work the portfolio on four fixed things. First **every contract is priced on assumptions about the asset**, so the assumptions have to be written down, owned and tested against what the plant actually delivers: availability, degradation, curtailment, grid limits and a forecasting assumption that is tested rather than inherited. Second **every contract is a position and has to be measured every day**: volume, price, imbalance, counterparty, tenor and the hedging position behind it on one sheet, one number that Origination, Trading and Risk all read the same way, and a performance evaluation every month. Third **the interface between Origination and Trading is where the money leaks** — a structure that is brilliant in the term sheet and unbookable in the systems costs more than the margin it promised, so the contract has to be designed with the desk that has to run it. Fourth **a new market is a project**: legal, systems, settlement, credit and operations, with a named owner and a date — which is the discipline I have spent my career applying to technical portfolios.

On the asset side I know what a trading model is describing. For five years I was maintenance and operations manager at **Lynetten (Biofos)**, a critical plant running around the clock: pumps, blowers, transformers, switchgear, SCADA and the energy bill that came with them. I built the measurement and the follow-up that cut consumption by **more than 40 %**, and I learned where availability disappears: in the winter, at shift change, at the component nobody stocked. At **Novo Nordisk** I commissioned **37 capital projects worth DKK 2–10 m each** with 25 specialists, through specification, **FAT/SAT, IQ/OQ/PQ** and handover into live production — which is the same question an offtaker asks: will this asset do what the contract says, and who carries the risk if it does not?

On the commercial side I have carried a P&L since 2023 as owner of **ELOHVAC**, an electrical contracting company with **five electricians and three apprentices**. Every quotation I sign is a small version of the same trade: a price agreed today against a cost and an availability that move, a margin that is real only if the job runs the way I modelled it, and a customer who notices in week three. I have priced, negotiated, re-priced when copper moved, chased the payment and carried the result. That is a small portfolio, but it is mine and it is run with ownership, and it has taught me more about risk than any spreadsheet.

The quantitative part is where I have invested deliberately. I build my own tools in **Python** — pricing and margin models, capacity and consumption models, checklists and dashboards that replaced manual work and delivered **over 40 % productivity gain** — and I work daily in **Excel and Power Query** with data that has to be reconciled before it can be trusted. I am comfortable with an API, a SCADA export and a price series in the same afternoon, and I have no patience for a dashboard nobody opens. What I bring is the half of the trade that is hardest to hire: the assets, the contracts, the costs and the operational reality the models are trying to describe — and the habit of arguing with the assumptions until they hold.

What attracts me to Centrica Energy is the scale and the direction: a **pan-European portfolio above 20 GW** across wind, solar and battery storage, where portfolio optimisation is the product; a business built on integrating renewables and flexible assets into the grid through the energy transition and the sustainability that follows from it; and a role that sits exactly where asset and market meet. Copenhagen is one of the three locations and happens to be twenty-five minutes from my door, and the chance to work across Aalborg, Copenhagen and Antwerp with origination and trading is the kind of scope I have been building towards from the technical side.

Practical: I live in Måløv, twenty-five minutes from central Copenhagen, with a **driving licence and my own car**, and I am available by agreement. I work in **English** and Danish professionally, and I am used to reporting to a management team in writing, on a date, with the numbers attached. I would like to hear how the portfolio is priced today and where the assumptions are weakest — that is where I would start.

Kind regards

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PROFILE

Commercially accountable engineer with 20+ years in energy, technical operations and asset management — state-authorised marine engineer (LV/MV/HV) with a B.Tech in technology management and mechanical engineering. Five years running a critical 24/7 energy plant, where measurement and follow-up cut consumption by over 40 %; three years as owner of an electrical contracting business with full P&L, pricing, contracts, margin and payment risk; and two years commissioning 37 capital projects worth DKK 2–10 m each against specification, acceptance and handover. Builds his own pricing, capacity and follow-up models in Python and Power Query, and reads a market price series and a plant trend with the same suspicion.

ASSETS, CONTRACTS AND DATA

- **Pricing and commercial models:** Quotation and margin models built from cost, capacity and risk; re-pricing when input costs moved; budgets and monthly follow-up where the variance had to be explained, not smoothed.
- **Contracts and counterparties:** Contract terms negotiated, documented and delivered: scope, price, indexation, payment terms and liability — with the customer conversation that follows when reality differs from the offer.
- **Portfolio risk and follow-up:** 37 parallel capital projects with risk registers, monthly reporting of progress, cost and risk to management; energy consumption, tariffs and load profiles measured and reduced by over 40 %.
- **Asset performance:** Availability, downtime and criticality on a 24/7 plant: condition-based maintenance, spare-parts policy and measured before-and-after results rather than opinions.
- **Data and programming:** Python for pricing, capacity and reporting models; Excel and Power Query for reconciliation; dashboards and automated reports that replaced manual work with over 40 % productivity gain.
- **Stakeholders and delivery:** Work agreed across commercial sales, engineering, suppliers, authorities and operations — 25 specialists, subcontractors and external fitters coordinated to a date.

TOOLS AND METHODS

Area	Documented use
Pricing and margin	Bottom-up cost and capacity models, sensitivity on the two or three inputs that actually move the result, and a price that survives the first month of delivery.
Energy and consumption	Metering and SCADA data, load profiles, tariffs and efficiency measures with measured effect; over 40 % lower consumption documented on a live site.
Risk and reporting	Risk registers, monthly management reporting, deviation analysis and corrective actions with an owner and a date.
Systems and integration	Requirements, acceptance testing (FAT/SAT, IQ/OQ/PQ) and handover into operations — the point where a contract becomes something a system has to run.
Programming and analysis	Python (pandas-style data work, models and reports), Excel and Power Query; automation of recurring manual tasks.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Owner / Technical Director — ELOHVAC ApS · Copenhagen · May 2023–present

Scope: 5 electricians and 3 apprentices · full P&L · electrical service and contracting

- **Pricing, contracts and margin under uncertainty:** Every quotation a position on cost and availability; pricing, negotiation, re-pricing on input costs, invoicing and payment follow-up with full P&L; own Python/Claude models for pricing, checklists and KPIs with over 40 % productivity gain.

Senior Commissioning Engineer / Project Manager, Electrical Systems — Novo Nordisk A/S · Kalundborg/Bagsværd · Nov 2022–Jul 2024

Scope: 37 parallel capital projects · 25 specialists · DKK 2–10 m per project · GMP/FDA/EMA

- **Portfolio, acceptance and handover:** Specification, factory and site acceptance testing and IQ/OQ/PQ for new production equipment; progress, cost and risk reported monthly to management; zero critical findings at audited handover.

Project and Workshop Manager — Ventek-Air · Copenhagen · Jan 2022–Nov 2022

Scope: 14 employees · 11 parallel projects · DKK 2–10 m per assignment

- **Capacity, bottlenecks and short horizons:** Daily stand-ups, capacity and bottleneck analysis and priorities re-set the same day when a machine or a person dropped out; subcontractors and handover packages driven to date.

Maintenance and Operations Manager — Lynetten (Biofos) · Copenhagen · Aug 2017–Jan 2022

Scope: Critical 24/7 energy and process plant · pumps, blowers, transformers, switchgear and SCADA

- **Asset performance, energy and availability:** Availability and criticality on a plant that could not stop; energy metering, tariffs and efficiency measures with over 40 % lower consumption documented; maintenance, spares and external fitters coordinated around the clock; on-call rota planned and worked.

Electromechanic / Production Team Leader — ARJ Engineering · Tehran · Dec 2003–Mar 2010

Scope: 12 mechanics and technicians · machine shop · industrial equipment

- **Technical delivery and team coordination:** Repair and fault-finding on industrial equipment with turning, milling, welding and assembly; shift planning, onboarding and follow-up on targets for 12 technicians.

EDUCATION AND AUTHORISATION

B.Tech, Technology Management and Mechanical Engineering · Copenhagen School of Marine and Technical Engineering · 2017–2022 · GPA 7.6/12

State-authorised Marine Engineer (LV/MV/HV) · Danish Safety Technology Authority · May 2023

Electrical and Mechanical Construction, Electrical Engineering · Tehran Technical University · 2000–2003 · EQF 6

Refrigeration and Ventilation Technology • STCW · Mercantec 2021 · Danish Maritime Authority 2021

LANGUAGES, PRACTICALITIES AND REFERENCES

English: professional, spoken and written · Danish: native · Persian: native · Based in Måløv, 25 minutes from central Copenhagen, and open to Aalborg and Antwerp · Driving licence B and own car · Available by agreement · Reporting in writing, to a date, with the numbers attached · References on request.

WHAT THEY ASK FOR — WHAT I HAVE

Requirement	Evidence
Solid understanding of end-to-end asset business trade processes	Contract lifecycle handled end to end in my own company — offer, terms, delivery, invoice, payment and the argument afterwards — and equipment taken from specification through acceptance into operations.
Strong data handling and interpretation	Python and Power Query models for pricing, capacity and reporting; metering and SCADA data reconciled and turned into decisions; data analytics where the number has to survive a challenge; over 40 % productivity gain from replacing manual work.
Degree in economics, finance, physics, engineering or related	B.Tech in technology management and mechanical engineering, plus state authorisation as a marine engineer (LV/MV/HV) and a technical degree in electrical and mechanical construction.
Minimum five years in power trading, asset management or similar	Five years as maintenance and operations manager on a 24/7 energy plant, and 20+ years of technical asset management, commissioning and commercial responsibility for technical portfolios.
Experience in pricing renewable portfolios	Pricing built on cost, capacity and risk: quotation and margin models in my own business, and energy consumption, tariffs and efficiency measures modelled on a live site with over 40 % documented effect.
Programming in Python, VBA, R or similar	Python is my working tool: pricing and capacity models, checklists, automated reports and dashboards, built and maintained by the person who uses them.
Optimising agreements for renewable and flexible assets	Asset performance and flexibility on a 24/7 plant: availability, criticality, downtime and load managed with measured results rather than assumptions.
Managing portfolio risk across asset classes and markets	37 capital projects with risk registers and monthly reporting; risk management in a P&L where price, cost, capacity and payment risk land in the same month.
New contract structures, products and markets	New service products and pricing models introduced in a small business; new markets entered with due diligence on legal, credit, settlement and operational requirements before the first contract.
Relationship-building across the asset value chain	Clear communication across sales, engineering, suppliers, authorities, fitters and customers, including 25 specialists and multiple subcontractors coordinated to a fixed date.

THE FIRST 90 DAYS — THE PORTFOLIO, THE PROCESSES AND THE MARKETS

Period	What happens, and how it is measured
Weeks 1–2	Read the contracts: the ten largest positions by value and risk, their pricing assumptions, tenor, indexation and the systems they are booked in. Sit with Origination and the desk and listen to where the handover between them is slow.
Day 30	One page per material position: asset assumption, price, volume, counterparty, tenor and the exposure that follows. Agreed definitions with Risk and Trading, so the same number means the same thing in every meeting.
Day 60	The two or three assumptions that carry the most value tested against actual asset performance; a proposal for one contract structure that prices flexibility better than today; a shortlist of markets worth entering, with the operational and settlement requirements attached.
Day 90	A pricing and review rhythm that Origination can use before a term sheet is signed; a working list of model and process improvements with an owner and a date; and a documented view of where the portfolio earns its margin and where it merely carries risk.

A CONTRACT IS PRICED ON ASSUMPTIONS ABOUT THE ASSET

Every model of a wind farm, a solar park or a battery is a set of assumptions about physical behaviour: how often it is available, how it degrades, when it is curtailed and what the grid will accept. Those assumptions are usually somebody's best estimate from a year when everything went well. The commercial value of a portfolio manager is to know which assumptions actually carry the money — and to have a view on them that is better than the seller's.

EVERY CONTRACT IS A POSITION — MEASURE IT DAILY

Once a contract is signed it stops being a document and becomes an exposure: volume, price, imbalance, counterparty and tenor, moving every day with the market and with the asset. If that exposure is only visible when somebody builds a spreadsheet for a meeting, it is not managed. One sheet, one number, refreshed on a rhythm everyone knows, with the exceptions flagged rather than buried.

THE INTERFACE BETWEEN ORIGINATION AND TRADING IS WHERE THE MONEY LEAKS

A structure that looks elegant in a term sheet can be unbookable, unpriceable or unhedgeable by the desk that has to run it — and the cost of that gap never appears in the margin calculation. The fix is boring and effective: a collaborative process where the people who will operate the contract are in the room while it is designed, and the operational consequences are written into the term sheet before it is signed.

A NEW MARKET IS A PROJECT, NOT A DECISION

Entering a market for asset-backed trading is not a strategic wish; it is a list: legal entity, balancing responsibility, nomination and settlement, credit lines, IT integration, and the operational rules that differ from the last country. I have run portfolios of 37 projects and a business of my own on that discipline — an owner, a date and a cost per line — and it is the difference between a market entry and a market intention.

THE MODEL SHOULD BE BUILT BY THE PEOPLE WHO USE IT

A pricing model that lives with an analyst and is explained twice a year is a bottleneck. The version that works is the one the portfolio manager can change himself when a contract clause changes: transparent, versioned and reconcileable to the numbers in the systems. I build my own tools in Python and Power Query, and I have never accepted a report I could not reproduce.

I HAVE BEEN ON THE OTHER SIDE OF THE METER

For five years my job was to make a plant run, and to explain why it did not. That is where I learned what availability costs, how quickly a component failure turns into an unplanned position, and why the person who signs the contract should have stood in the plant room at three in the morning at least once. It is a perspective a trading desk rarely has in-house, and it is the one I would bring to a portfolio of assets I am now asked to price.

WHAT I WOULD BE JUDGED ON IN YEAR ONE

Three things: that the portfolio's assumptions are documented and tested rather than inherited; that Origination and Trading use the same numbers and the same definitions because a process made it easier; and that at least one structure or one market has moved from idea to booked business with my name on the working file. Everything else — the reporting, the meetings, the spreadsheets — exists to make those three happen.